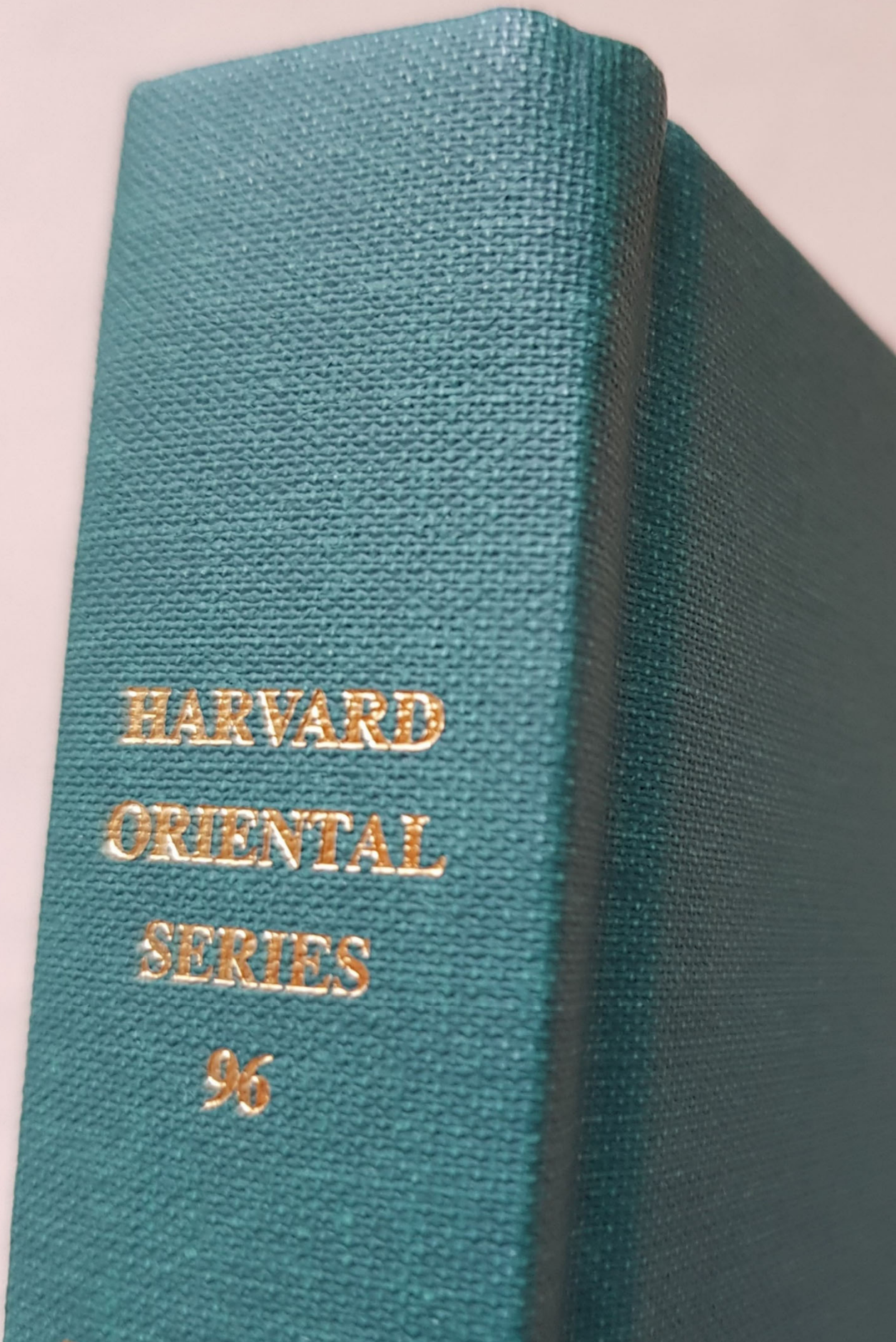

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UTPALADEVA ON THE POWER OF ACTION

A FIRST EDITION, ANNOTATED TRANSLATION AND STUDY OF *ĪŚVARAPRATYABHIJÑĀVIVṚTI*, CHAPTER 2.1

by

Isabelle Ratié

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Pour Alexis Sanderson et Raffaele Torella, en signe d'admiration

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FOREWORD

The following pages contain the edition, translation and study of a hitherto unknown chapter of a Sanskrit text that has only come down to us in fragments, namely, the detailed commentary (*Vivṛti*) written by the Kashmirian Utpaladeva (c. 925–975 CE) so as to explain one of his own philosophical treatises, a major Śaiva nondualistic work entitled the *Recognition of the Lord* (*Īśvarapratyabhijñā*). Three chapters of this *Vivṛti* have recently come to light; the present book focuses on the first and shortest among them, chapter 2.1, which is devoted to the examination of the power of action (*kriyāśakti*) that the Śaivas ascribe to every conscious being. The chapter's main point is to show that even though the core of consciousness, i.e., its power to become aware of itself or to grasp itself, is the subtlest form of action, sequence (*krama*), whether temporal or spatial, only belongs to lower forms of action, so that Śiva—understood as an infinite, omniscient and omnipotent consciousness—has a dynamic essence without being in any way spatially or temporally limited. The text therefore discusses the nature of ordinary actions performed by transmigrating individuals as well as that of Śiva's cosmic creation, while engaging in debates on the nature of space and time. The first chapter of the book discusses the place of Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* within the *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* corpus and relates how its known fragments were discovered. Chapter 2 describes the manuscript sources used for the edition. Chapter 3 provides a brief overview of Utpaladeva's system and of the philosophical context in which he wrote his treatise. Chapters 4 to 10 contain a detailed analysis of the text, the translation of which is given in chapter 11; the Sanskrit original is edited in chapter 12.

The recent discovery of parts of the detailed commentary that Utpaladeva composed to explain his own magnum opus has amply confirmed that his system is one of the most refined and original in the history of Indian philosophy; that he was the main innovator as far as Śaiva nondualistic philosophy is concerned; and that the *Vivṛti* was the most important textual layer of the *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* treatise. But the text edited here is not easy to

understand. This is so for several reasons, not least of which are its polemical yet very elliptical character and the fact that despite years of painstaking (some might say: obsessive) efforts to gather fragments of this text from various annotations scribbled in the margins of manuscripts, I have failed to fill several remaining lacunae in the edition. Besides, we are fortunate enough to have at our disposal two brilliant commentaries on the *Īśvara-pratyabhijñā* treatise by Abhinavagupta (c. 975–1025 CE), one of which is devoted to the *Vivṛti*; alas, however, Abhinavagupta does not comment on every aspect of Utpaladeva's text—far from that. For all these reasons, as well as, of course, my own shortcomings as a translator and historian, I still have numerous doubts about the translation and interpretations provided below, and I am painfully aware that they must still contain many errors. Hopefully these, once published, can be corrected by others more learned than me; and I will certainly have occasion for offering additional corrections in the forthcoming study of another, longer chapter of the *Vivṛti* that I am currently editing and translating.

This book is dedicated to two great masters of Śaiva studies, Alexis Sanderson and Raffaele Torella. Alexis Sanderson taught me to read Abhinavagupta's commentaries; and as explained below, without Raffaele Torella's pioneering studies on the Pratyabhijñā treatise, this book could not have been written, in this form or indeed any other. They know how hopelessly indebted I am to them; may they forgive the mistakes that they will undoubtedly spot in this work.

I also owe Harunaga Isaacson—whose astounding scholarship is only matched by his generosity—a debt of gratitude that I fear I can never repay in full, as he went with incredible swiftness and efficiency through more than two hundred pages of a previous version of this book, spotting mistakes of all kinds and significantly improving the manuscript in the process. Heartfelt thanks are also due to all the friends and colleagues with whom I read and discussed passages of this text in three workshops on Sanskrit works: *Chance and Contingency in Indian Philosophy*, organized by Phyllis Granoff (Yale University, New Haven, 2017); *Unpublished Editions of Kashmirian Sanskrit Texts*, organized by Jürgen Hanneder and myself (Sorbonne Nouvelle University, Paris, 2018); and the *Second Workshop in compared philosophy (India and the medieval West)*, organized by Hugo David, Vincent Eltschinger and Irène Rosier-Catach (EFEO Centre, Pondicherry,

2019). Special thanks are due to Phyllis Granoff, whose remarks on Abhinavagupta's explanation of a passage devoted to verse 2.1.4 were extremely helpful. Michael Witzel offered insightful remarks on the descriptions of manuscripts in chapter 2, and as explained below, I owe him and Makoto Fushimi the date proposed for D2. Johannes Bronkhorst spotted additional typos and shared a paper of his. Important passages in Abhinavagupta's *Tantrāloka* and Helārāja's *Prakīrṇaprakāśa* were respectively brought to my attention by Whitney Cox (who also carefully read the first five chapters and spotted various typos and infelicities) and Vincenzo Vergiani (who went through a couple of pages on technical grammatical issues and pointed out several inadequacies in them). Daniele Cuneo patiently listened to some of my far-fetched hypotheses on manuscript matters and read a couple of pages pertaining to a technical term of *alaṅkāraśāstra*. Emmanuel Francis and Giovanni Ciotti had a look at some of the manuscript scans at my disposal to confirm my hypotheses regarding some annotations in Southern scripts. Luther Obrock shared images of a Śāradā manuscript preserved at McGill University. I am also deeply grateful to the students who attended my graduate seminars on Indian philosophy at the Sorbonne Nouvelle in 2019–2020 and bravely suffered through a reading of the greater part of this *Vivṛti* chapter: Fabienne Bagnis, Beatrice Bonino, Clémentine Peroumal, Anaïs Dornier-Viavant, Sébastien Monassa, Lucas Pasquet and Hervé Pauly—it has been a great joy to read Utpaladeva and Abhinavagupta with them.

Thanks are also due to the libraries that have enabled me to study manuscripts of the Pratyabhijñā tradition. They are too numerous to be all mentioned here (see the bibliography below, part 1), but I am particularly grateful to the staff of the Shri Ragunatha Temple Manuscript Library (Jammu), the National Archives of India (Delhi) and the Library of the School of Oriental and African Studies (London). It should also be noted that in many cases, I gained access to the manuscripts consulted for this edition thanks to their digitization by the National Mission for Manuscripts. Last but not least, I am very grateful to Chetan Pandey, who has been photographing Kashmirian Sanskrit manuscripts in various institutions and private collections for years and has not spared efforts to make them easily accessible to all scholars (see https://egangotri.wordpress.com/). It is thanks to him in particular that I gained access to one of the most important manuscripts for the present work (J11).